

Case Study: Modernizing Chase First Banking

Overview

Chase initiated a strategic modernization effort to migrate Chase First Banking from a third-party platform to an in-house solution. The initiative reduced long-term vendor costs, gave Chase ownership of the customer experience, and laid the foundation for faster product innovation. The migration impacted approximately 1.5 million Chase First Banking accounts and required maintaining customer trust while introducing a redesigned experience.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER – Project overview / migration timeline]

The Business Challenge

The existing Chase First Banking experience relied on an external vendor to power core money management capabilities, including spending controls, savings goals, allowances, chores, and transaction history. Moving these capabilities in-house represented a multi-million-dollar strategic investment, but success depended on more than rebuilding features—it required helping over a million customers transition without confusion or increased support calls.

The redesign also needed to improve engagement with key financial management features while preserving familiar mental models for existing customers.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER – Background / business problem slides]

My Role

I joined the project during implementation as a UX Designer responsible for translating validated concepts into production-ready experiences. My primary ownership was the Savings Goals workflow, but I first immersed myself in the usability findings to understand the broader product strategy, customer behaviors, and interaction patterns.

Rather than simply recreating screens, I used the research to understand why design decisions had been made, proactively clarified implementation details, reduced ambiguity for engineering, and ensured the delivered experience remained faithful to the validated user experience.

Research Insights

Research across 62 participants showed that the redesigned dashboard was intuitive and well received, with an overall satisfaction score of 4.77/5. A consistent pattern emerged: users rarely struggled with completing tasks once they located the correct feature. Instead, discoverability and mental models created friction.

For Savings Goals:

- 100% task completion
- 4.58/5 ease-of-use
- Many participants initially looked under 'More' before navigating to Savings.
- Researchers recommended strengthening dashboard signifiers rather than redesigning the workflow.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER – Research findings and Task 5 slides]

My Approach

I reviewed usability findings beyond my assigned feature to understand how Savings Goals fit into the overall information architecture. This systems-level understanding allowed me to:

- Preserve research-validated interaction patterns.
- Produce implementation-ready designs with clear specifications.
- Anticipate engineering questions before development.
- Align the delivered experience with the team's long-term migration strategy rather than treating the feature as an isolated screen.

Solution

The final implementation integrated Savings Goals into the redesigned parent dashboard, supporting Chase's broader goal of centralizing money management while maintaining a simple, approachable experience. The design balanced familiarity for existing customers with clearer organization for new users, supporting the transition from the legacy platform.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER – Final dashboard and Savings Goal designs]

Impact

- Supported a strategic migration affecting approximately 1.5 million Chase First Banking accounts.
- Contributed to a platform modernization expected to save Chase millions by eliminating third-party vendor dependence.
- Delivered production-ready designs informed by research rather than assumptions.
- Helped preserve validated usability outcomes, including 100% task completion and a 4.58/5 ease-of-use score for Savings Goals.
- Contributed to an overall dashboard experience that achieved a 4.77/5 satisfaction rating and was consistently described as intuitive, straightforward, and user-friendly.

Reflection

This project reinforced the importance of understanding the business strategy behind a feature, not just the interface. By grounding implementation in research and systems thinking, I was able to bridge design and engineering while helping deliver a high-priority modernization initiative with significant customer and business impact.